

DERRON BORDERS

KANSAS STATE UNIVERSITY, MANHATTAN, KS

Research

My research sits at the intersection of social epistemology and adult learning, with a particular focus on how people break free from hegemonic frames—the deeply embedded worldviews shaped by ideology, power, and social belonging. I study how adults in so-called “post-truth” societies navigate—and sometimes transcend—epistemic bubbles, echo chambers, and neoliberal discourses that shape public understanding of political issues.

Keywords: adult learning, social epistemology, hegemony, critical andragogy, transformative learning

Academic Preparation

- 2024 – Present  **Ph.D., Adult Learning & Leadership** (*in progress*) – Kansas State University
- 2014 – 2016  **M.A., College Student Personnel** – Bowling Green State University
- 2010 – 2014  **M.A., Linguistics** – University of Utah
Thesis title: *The role of gender socialization and sibilants in the perception of gay- and straight-sounding voices: a study of returned Latter-day Saint missionaries in Utah*
Committee: Mariana Di Paolo (Chair), Aaron Kaplan, Lisa Diamond
- 2005 – 2008  **B.A., Linguistics, Cum Laude** – The Ohio State University
- 2005 – 2008  **B.A., French, Cum Laude** – The Ohio State University
- 2003 – 2005  **Completed 69 credit hours towards A.A. in Humanities,** – Columbus State Community College

Administrative Experience

- 2024 – 2026  **Investigator**, Office of Civil Rights and Title IX, Kansas State University
- 2021 – 2023  **Director**, Office of Diversity and Inclusion, Samuel Curtis Johnson Graduate School of Management, Cornell University
- 2020 – 2021  **Assistant Director of Student Life and Academic Programming**, Cornell in Washington, Brooks School of Public Policy, Cornell University
- 2016 – 2020  **Director**, Language House, West Campus House System, Cornell University
- 2014 – 2016  **Graduate Coordinator**, Ethnic Student Center, Office of Multicultural Affairs, Bowling Green State University
- 2013  **Graduate Research Associate**, National Center for Voice and Speech, University of Utah
- 2010 – 2014  **Project Manager**, Shoshoni Language Project, University of Utah
- 2010 – 2013  **Teaching Assistant**, Department of Linguistics, University of Utah

Industry Experience

- 2011 – 2013  **Lead, Language Development**, UnBound Games, Salt Lake City, UT
- 2008  **Associate Transcriber**, VoiceBox Technologies, Bellevue, WA

Graduate Experience

- 2014 – 2016  **Graduate Coordinator**, Ethnic Student Center, Office of Multicultural Affairs, Bowling Green State University
- 2013  **Graduate Research Associate**, National Center for Voice and Speech, University of Utah
- 2010 – 2014  **Project Manager**, Shoshoni Language Project, University of Utah
- 2010 – 2013  **Teaching Assistant**, Department of Linguistics, University of Utah

Teaching Experience

- 2010 – 2013  **Instructor of Record**, Department of Linguistics, University of Utah
- Teaching & Learning Across Languages (ESL 1600), American History for ESL (ESL 1700), Cross Cultural Communication (LING 3600), Expository Writing for ESL (ESL 1060)
- 2009 – 2010  **Auxiliar de inglés (teaching assistant)**, North American Language and Culture Assistants Program, Spain
- 9th-12th grade
- 2008 – 2009  **Assistant d'anglais (teaching assistant)**, Teaching Assistant Program in France
- K-6th grade

Volunteer Roles

- 2025 – Present  **Administrative Coordinator**, Flint Hills, Kansas Chapter, Democratic Socialists of America
-  **Youth Exchange Officer**, Konza Manhattan Rotary Club

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Borders, D.** (in press). Pre-dialogic agonism: Adult learning, hegemony, and the epistemic crisis of “post-truth”. *Adult Education Quarterly*.

Presentations, Lectures, and Workshops

Scholarly Paper Presentations (Refereed)

- Borders, D.** (2026). Why thoughts alone don't change minds: Rethinking education in a "post-truth" era. *K-State Graduate Research, Arts, and Discovery Forum*.
- Borders, D.** (2025a). Raising class consciousness: Adult learning in a socialist book club. *American Association For Adult and Continuing Education*.
- Borders, D.** (2025b). Toward a decolonized andragogy: Addressing the limits of neoliberal adult education. *American Association For Adult and Continuing Education*.
- Borders, D.** (2019). Decolonizing gender and sexual identity development of Indigenous students. *ACPA - College Student Educators International*.
- Alzoubi, A., & **Borders, D.** (2014). (NG) in Utah: Retention or innovation? *University of Utah Student Conference in Linguistics*.

- Borders, D.** (2014). Gay- and straight-sounding voices: Gender socialization of returned Latter-day Saint missionaries. *University of Utah Student Conference in Linguistics*.
- Alzoubi, A., **Borders, D.**, & Di Paolo, M. (2013). (NG) in Utah English. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation* 42.
- Borders, D.** (2011). An immersive and collaborative approach to teaching Indigenous languages: The Co-Teaching American Indian Language Immersion Program. *University of Utah Student Conference in Linguistics*.

Conference Presentations (Refereed)

- Barfield, T., **Borders, D.**, Briley, V. L., Fiala, M., & Haller, L. B. (2025a). Answering the “call to cohort:” takeaways from piloting a studio for designing dissertation research. *American Association For Adult and Continuing Education*.
- Barfield, T., **Borders, D.**, Briley, V. L., Fiala, M., & Haller, L. B. (2025b). Experiential learning for scholars: Building community through designing research. *American Association For Adult and Continuing Education*.
- Borders, D.**, McGhee, A., & Vital, C.-S. (2022). Fatphobia in higher education: A panel discussion. *Cornell Inclusive Excellence Summit 2022*.
- Borders, D.**, & Allbaugh, H. (2022). The intersection of anti-fatness with food, health, and wellness. *ACPA - College Student Educators International*.
- McGhee, A., **Borders, D.**, Due, J. N., & Allbaugh, H. (2022). Fatphobia in the workplace - stories from fat SA professionals. *ACPA - College Student Educators International*.
- Borders, D.**, & Strass, K. (2019). Student development of Native American identity through language revitalization programs. *ACPA - College Student Educators International*.

Invited Talks

- Borders, D.** (2022). Fatphobia in medicine. *Rosalind Franklin University of Medicine and Science*.
- Borders, D.** (2012). Language, gender, and sexuality. *LING 3600: Cross-cultural Communication*.
- Hansen, L., & **Borders, D.** (2012). Language acquisition as an international student in an American university. *Global Pathways' Spring 2012 Meeting*.

Selected Workshops (Facilitator)

- Borders, D.** (2023). Trans inclusion in the workplace. *SC Johnson College of Business*.
- Borders, D.** (2020). Diversity and inclusion aren't enough: Towards equity and justice in business student orgs. *Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management*.
- Di Paolo, M., **Borders, D.**, Pynes, J., Mitchell, J., Arnoff, S., Broncho, S., Martin, J., & Griffith, T. (2014). Foundations for learning: Increasing Shoshoni language use in early-childhood learners. *Shoshoni Language Teacher Education Workshop*.
- Di Paolo, M., **Borders, D.**, Pynes, J., Mitchell, J., & Arnoff, S. (2013). Breaking through barriers: Increasing the use of Shoshoni in classrooms & communities. *Shoshoni Language Teacher Education Workshop*.
- Di Paolo, M., Hudson, B. J., & **Borders, D.** (2011). Workshop on teaching American Indian languages to beginning level adults: Oral language development. *8th Annual Conference on Endangered Languages and Cultures of Native America*.

University, College, & Department Service

Cornell University

University Level:

- 2022-2023  Elected Member, SC Johnson College of Business Representative, Employee Assembly
- 2020-2021  Selected Member, Building Bridges - Diverse Talent Recruitment and Retention Task Force

College Level:

- 2021-2023  Chair, Measurement and Accountability Committee, Dean's Leadership Council on Combatting Racism and Promoting Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Belonging, SC Johnson College of Business

Department Level:

- 2022-2023  Chair, Johnson Anti-Racism Initiative, SC Johnson Graduate School of Management
- 2020-2021  Chair, Cornell in Washington DEI Strategic Planning Committee, Cornell in Washington

Bowling Green State University

University Level:

-  Graduate Diversity and Belonging Representative, Graduate Student Senate

University of Utah

Department Level:

- 2012  Organizing Chair, University of Utah Student Conference in Linguistics
- 2011-2012  Chair, Graduate Student Advisory Committee in Linguistics, Department of Linguistics
-  Selected Member, Organizing Committee for the Annual Conference on Endangered Languages and Cultures of Native America, Center for American Indian Languages

National Service

Professional Membership

- 2024 – Present  American Association For Adult and Continuing Education
- 2015 – 2023  ACPA - College Student Educators International
- 2022 – 2023  National Association of Diversity Officers in Higher Education
- 2015 – 2017  NASPA - Student Affairs Administrators in Higher Education
- 2012 – 2015  American Dialect Society
-  International Gender and Language Association
- 2011 – 2013  American Anthropological Association
- 2010 – 2015  Linguistics Society of America

Leadership

- 2022-2023  **Chair, Membership and Outreach**, Indigenous Student Affairs Network, ACPA - *College Student Educators International*
- 2016-2022  **Chair, Marketing and Communications**, Indigenous Student Affairs Network, ACPA - *College Student Educators International*
- 2020  **Founder**, Coalition for Fat Identities, ACPA - *College Student Educators International*

Committee Work

- 2018-2022  Annual Conference Proposals Review Committee, ACPA - *College Student Educators International*

Awards & Honors

2013, 2014	🌟	Fellowship, Western American Language Research Group, University of Utah
2013	🌟	Salt Lake City Weekly Best of Utah Award, The Shoshoni Language Project Team
	🌟	National Indian Education Association's William G. Demmert Cultural Freedom Award, The Shoshoni Language Project Team

Skills & Knowledge

Administrative	📋	budgeting & bookkeeping, program and event coordination, project management, recruiting
Interpersonal	🤝	academic advising, career coaching, conflict resolution, crisis management, training development and facilitation, mediation
Policy	🏛️	Affirmative Action, Americans with Disabilities Act, Clery Act, Equal Opportunity Employment, FERPA, Title VI, Title VII, Title IX, VAWA
Strategic	📊	data analytics and assessment, risk analysis, strategic planning
Technical	💻	Adobe Creative Suite, Asana, Audacity, Canva, Canvas, CSS, FileMaker Pro, GitHub, Google Applications, HandShake, HTML, JavaScript, $\LaTeX$, Maxient, Microsoft 365, Notion, PeopleSoft, Praat, Qualtrics, R, Rise 360, Salesforce, social media management, Synthesia.io, Visual Studio Code, web development

Language Knowledge

Languages	🗣️	Arabic	● ● ● ● ●	<i>beginner</i>
		Catalan:	● ● ● ● ●	<i>advanced</i>
		Dutch:	● ● ● ● ●	<i>intermediate</i>
		English:	● ● ● ● ●	<i>native</i>
		Finnish	● ● ● ● ●	<i>beginner</i>
		French:	● ● ● ● ●	<i>fluent</i>
		German	● ● ● ● ●	<i>intermediate</i>
		Romanian	● ● ● ● ●	<i>beginner</i>
		Shoshoni	● ● ● ● ●	<i>field knowledge</i>
		Spanish:	● ● ● ● ●	<i>fluent</i>